

and ...Kg7-f6. Kamsky decides to allow the knight into e5 and instead pins his hopes on breaking up the black pawn structure. With best play the position may be a draw but it is very unpleasant to defend.

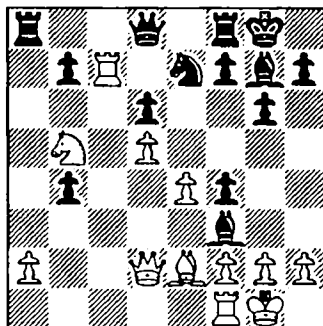


Diagram 4

Taking control of the dark squares

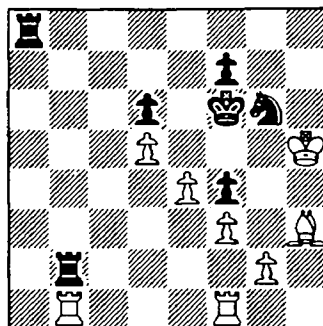


Diagram 5

The white king is in trouble

24 h4 gxh4 25 Kh2 Ng6 26 Kh3 Rb2 27 Bf5 Ne5 28 Kxh4 h6 29 Bh3 Kg7 30 Rdd1 Raa2 31 f3 Ng6+ 32 Kg4 Kf6 33 Rb1 h5+!

Suddenly the white king finds itself in a mating net.

34 Kxb5 Ra8! (Diagram 5) 35 Kg4

If 35 Rxb2 Rh8+ 36 Kg4 Rh4 mate.

35...Rh8 36 g3 Rh2

White stopped the mate but at the cost of his bishop.

37 Rh1 R8xh3 38 Rxh2 Rxh2 39 gxf4 Rg2+ 40 Kh3 Nxf4+ 41 Kh4 Ke5 42 Rb7 Kd4 43 Rxf7 Ke3 White resigns

The Bayonet 9 b4: The Main Line 10 Re1

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 (Diagram 6)

What is the point of 10 Re1?

The simple idea behind 10 Re1 is to meet 10...Nf4 with 11 Bf1. The bishop on f1 is very well placed defensively and it turns out that, despite its active appearance, the knight on f4 is actually quite poorly placed. There is nothing for it to attack and it can even get in the way of Black's kingside play. Black will also have to be constantly on the lookout for White playing Bxf4 at a favourable moment.

It took quite a while, and cost an awful lot of points, before Black players appreciated all this. Meanwhile, everyone was playing 9 b4. The old main lines, 9 Ne1 and 9 Nd2, just disappeared. The results

went overwhelmingly in White's favour. However, the tide finally appears to be turning. The main problem for Black was not the strength of 10 Re1, but the fact that he was playing too ambitiously. The King's Indian attracts players who are looking for a sharp struggle. Instead of trying to prove equality they were trying to destroy the Bayonet Attack. They didn't realise that the best way to destroy the Bayonet Attack is to prove equality! Once equality has been established, white players are bound to turn their attention elsewhere. This has been happening over the last year or so and we are beginning to see a bit less of the Bayonet Attack and a bit more of other variations in the King's Indian.

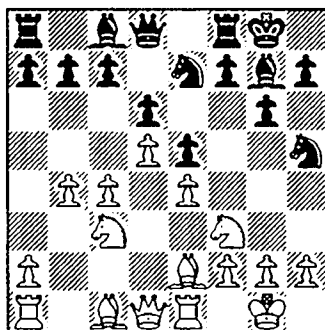


Diagram 6
The mysterious 10 Re1

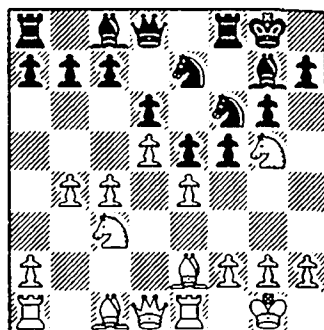


Diagram 7
The knight retreats

10...f5

There is no need for Black to commit himself to ...Nf4 (although this is examined in Game 22). Instead, he looks at the move ...Nh5 in the same way he would look at ...Ne8 or ...Nd7 – as a means of clearing the way for Black's traditional King's Indian advance ...f7-f5

11 Ng5

This is the critical test and the move that originally put many Black players off playing 10...f5. As in the line with 10 g3, the knight is heading for e6.

11...Nf6! (Diagram 7)

White was threatening 12 Bxh5 so the knight had to move. 11...Nf4 has also been played but it is less reliable than the text (12 Bxf4 exf4 13 Rc1 appears to favour White). From f6 the knight exerts more influence on the centre. Now White has two ways to defend his centre. In Games 23 and 24 we see 12 Bf3 while Game 25 deals with 12 f3.

Theoretical?

Extremely.

Statistics

Grim reading for Black. White has scored 62% in just over 900 games with 10 Re1. Not so many games but remember this variation only started a few years ago. Black does a bit better when he plays with 10...f5 and 11...Nf6 but White still scores a healthy 58%

Illustrative Games

Game 22

□ Kobalija ■ Smirnov

Russian Championship, Elista 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nb5 10 Re1 Nf4 11 Bf1 a5!? 12 bxa5 Rxa5 13 a4 c5

13...f5 can be played at once as 14 Bxf4 exf4 15 e5 dxe5 16 Nxe5 is not so good now because of the reply 16...Qd6!. White usually meets 13...f5 with 14 Nd2 and several games have continued 14...fxe4 15 Ndx4 Nf5 16 Nb5! with advantage to White.

14 Nb5 Ra6 15 Ra3! Nh5

A rather sad retreat. Black wants to play ...f7-f5 but can't because of the usual 16 Bxf4 exf4 17 e5. An alternative strategy is to play 15...h6 followed by ...g6-g5 and only then ...f7-f5 but numerous games have shown this is also insufficient for equality.

16 g3 Kh8 17 Nh4! Ng8

White's last two moves have been designed to prevent ...f7-f5, e.g 17...f5? 18 exf5 Nxf5 19 Nxf5 Bxf5 20 g4 and White wins a piece.

18 Ng2 Nhf6 19 Bb2 Nd7 20 Qa1 (Diagram 8)

White is preparing to play f2-f4!. His pieces have more scope so it makes sense for him to open the position.

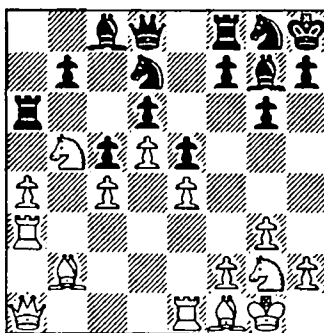


Diagram 8

Preparing to open up with f2-f4

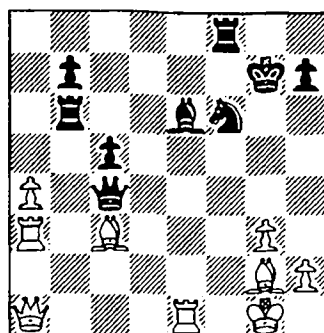


Diagram 9

The long diagonal pin is decisive

Starting Out: The King's Indian

20...f5?!

Black should have stayed passive with 20 Nf6 21 f4 f6. It won't be much fun but at least he won't get blown away in the centre.

21 exf5 gxf5 22 f4!

Now there is nothing Black can do to prevent the sacrifice on d6

22...Ne7 23 Nxd6! Rxd6 24 fxe5 Rb6 25 Bc3!

White wants to play e6 so he must first move his bishop.

25...Ng6 26 e6 Nf6 27 Nh4! Ne7 28 Bh3 Nexd5?!

Returning the material is hopeless because White is able to take the bishop on g7 and catch Black in a deadly pin on the long diagonal.

29 cxd5 Qxd5 30 Bg2 Qc4 31 Nxf5 Bxe6 32 Nxc7 Kxc7 (Diagram 9) 33 a5! Rd6 34 Ra4 Qd3 35 Rf4 Bd5 36 Rg4+ Kf7 37 Bxf6 Rxf6 38 Qe5?!

38 Qb1! was a quicker and more elegant way to win. The point is that after 38...Qxb1 White doesn't recapture but flicks in 39 Bxd5+.

38...Qd2 is also impossible on account of 39 Qxh7 mate.

38...Be6 39 Qh5+ Ke7 40 Qxc5+ Qd6 41 Rg7+ R8f7 42 Rxf7+ Rxf7 43 Qd5 Qd7 44 Qxb7 Black resigns

Game 23

□ Babula ■ Degraeve

Istanbul Olympiad 2000

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 f5 11 Ng5 Nf6! 12 Bf3

White defends his centre with pieces and envisages that his bishop on f3 will become active when the long diagonal opens. He can also defend his centre with a pawn move. 12 f3 is the subject of Game 25.

12...c6 (Diagram 10)

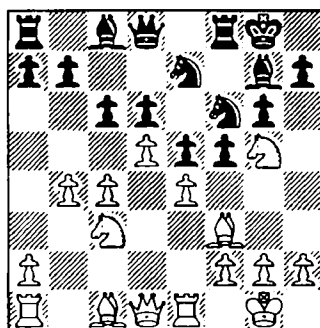


Diagram 10

A safer approach for Black

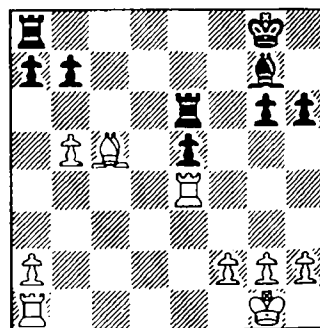


Diagram 11

Black is OK in the endgame

The tension in the centre is increased. Playing ...c7-c6 also gains space for Black on the queenside.

13 b5

White is waiting for Black waste time on ...h7-h6 before carrying out his Ne6 plan. The sharper 13 Be3 is the subject of the next game.

13...cxd5 14 cxd5 h6 15 Ne6 Bxe6 16 dxe6 fxe4 17 Nxe4 Nxe4 18 Bxe4 d5 19 Ba3

This is why White played 13 b5.

19...dxe4 20 Qxd8 Rfxd8 21 Bxe7 Re8 22 Bc5 Rxe6 23 Rxe4
(Diagram 11)

At first glance his endgame may look slightly better for White because Black has a central pawn restricting the activity of his bishop. In practice though he has had very little difficulty as his rooks are active and his king can come quickly to the centre.

23...a6! 24 b6 Rc8 25 Be3 Bf6 26 Rd1 Rd8 27 Rb1 Rc6 28 g4 h5 29 Kg2 Kf7 30 Kf3 Ke6 31 Ra4 Rf8 32 Kg2 Rfc8 33 h3 Rc4 34 Rxa6 bxa6 35 b7 Rb8 36 Ba7 Rxb7 37 Rxb7 Ra4 Draw agreed

Game 24

□ Xu Jun ■ Ye Jiangchuan

Shanghai 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 f5 11 Ng5 Nf6! 12 Bf3 c6 13 Be3

This is an attempt to lure Black into playing 13...f4 after which White would calmly return home with 14 Bc1. The move ...f5-f4 takes all the pressure off the centre so White is quite happy to spend two moves to achieve this. Black should now go in for the exchanging sequence that we have already seen in the previous game.

13...cxd5 14 cxd5 h6 15 Ne6 Bxe6 16 dxe6 fxe4 17 Nxe4 Nxe4 18 Bxe4 d5 (Diagram 12)

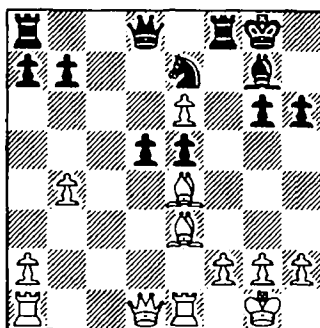


Diagram 12

A dynamically equal position

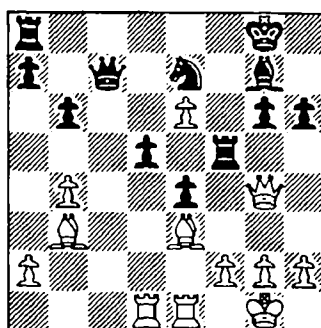


Diagram 13

Black consolidates his defences